



University of Essex

Online

Seminar 1

Introduction to Health

Psychology

Date:



Overview

- Introductions
- Overview of module
- Seminars – mutual expectations and how we can run them
- CLQ
- Any questions before we begin?
- Tutor email: gillian.smith@kaplan.com (anytime!)



Aims of the seminar

This week's seminar is designed to introduce you to the discipline of health psychology and some of the models and theories which help us understand, explain and predict our health behaviours.

You should prepare in advance for these discussions using information from the core textbooks and recommended reading.

This week we will **test your knowledge on:**

1. What does it mean to be healthy? What key factors might influence our perspective and how might this concept change over time?
2. What are the key theories and models which help explain our health behaviours? How useful are they in predicting behaviour change?



Overview of units

Unit	Topic	Assessment
1	Introduction to Health Psychology	
2	Understanding and Predicting Health Behaviours	
3	Health Promotion Interventions	CLQ poster and summary Peer responses Deadline:
4	Individual Differences	
5	Stress, Health and Coping	
6	Chronic Illness: Help-Seeking, Diagnosis, Adjustment	
7	Illness and Treatment Beliefs	
8	Psychological Processes at the End of Life	
9	The role of Psychology in Supporting Healthcare Professionals	Essay assignment: 2200 words: Deadline:



What is health psychology?

‘Scientific study of the psychological processes involved in health, illness and healthcare’ (Michie, 2004)

Four key areas:

1. The prevention and management of illness
2. The identification of psychological factors contributing to physical illness
3. The promotion and maintenance of health
4. Improvement of the healthcare system and formulation of health policy (Rodham, 2010 page xii)



Role of the Health Psychologist

Developing policies and procedures at national level

Intervention work

Clinical work

Teaching/Academia

Research

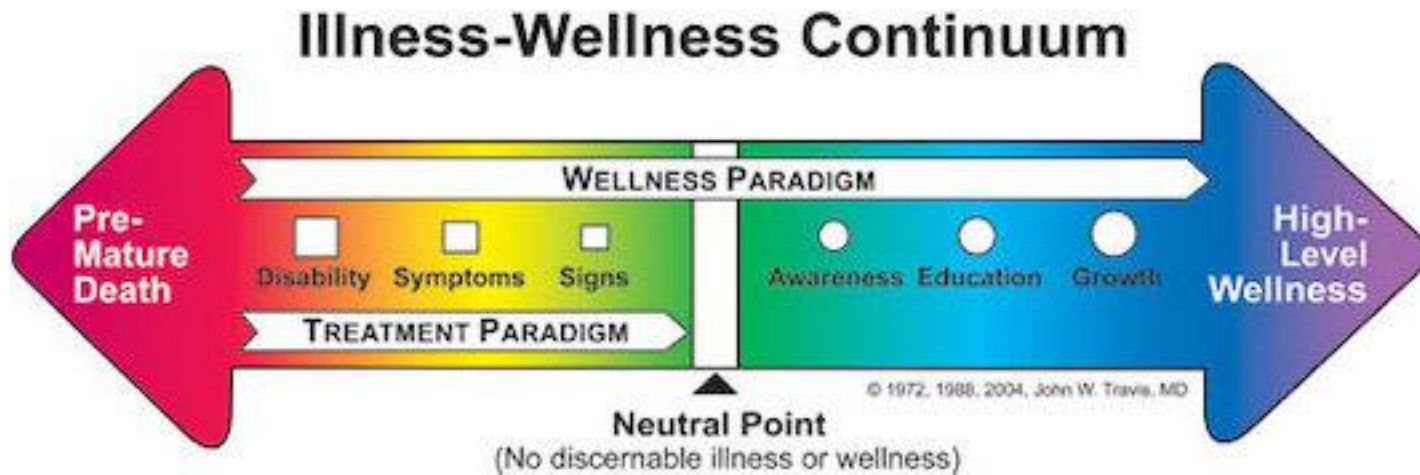


Question 1:

What does it mean to be healthy?



Illness – Wellness Continuum



Travis, 1972

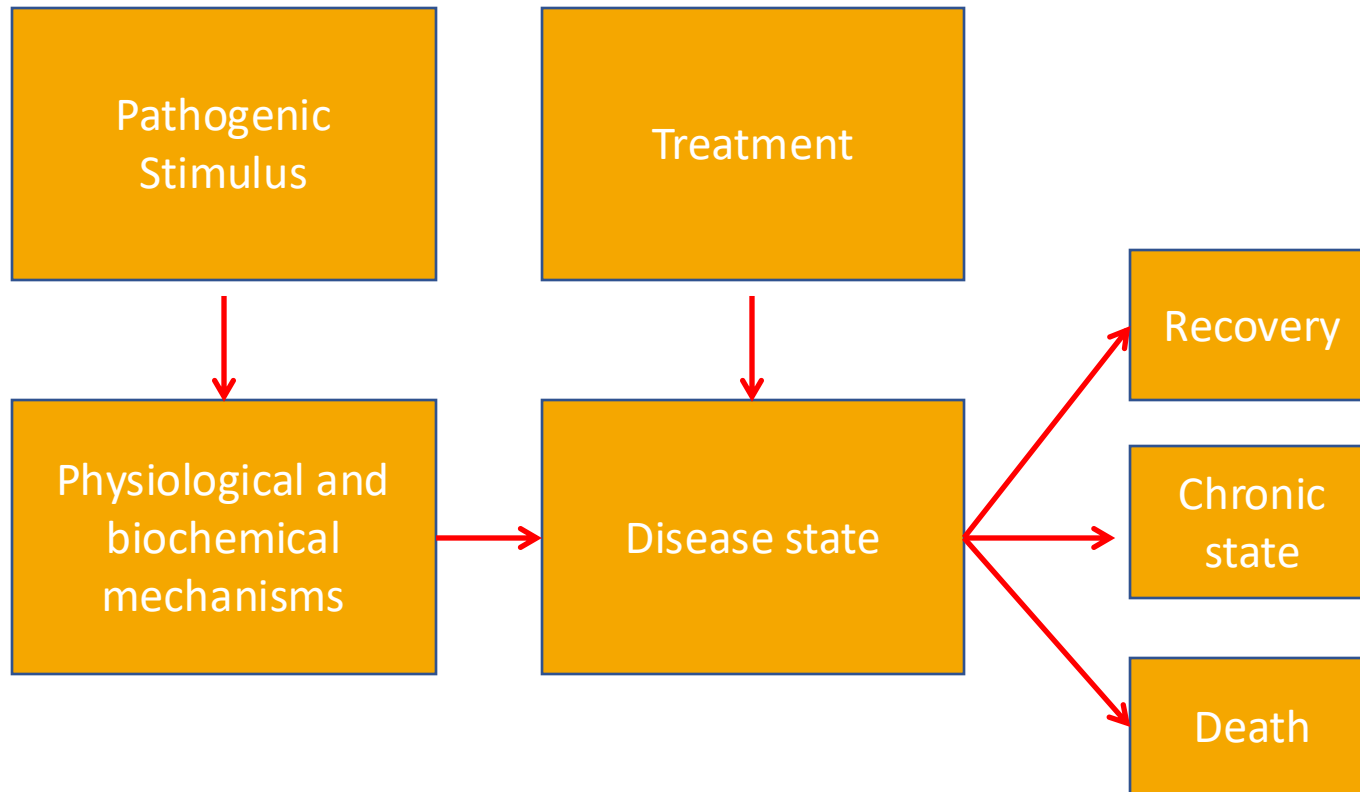


Biomedical model of disease

- The biomedical model explains health as the absence of disease
- Disease = any pathogen that upset the equilibrium of the physical body
- Dualistic model i.e., the mind and body exist in different realms
- All illness and all symptoms and signs arise from an underlying abnormality within the body

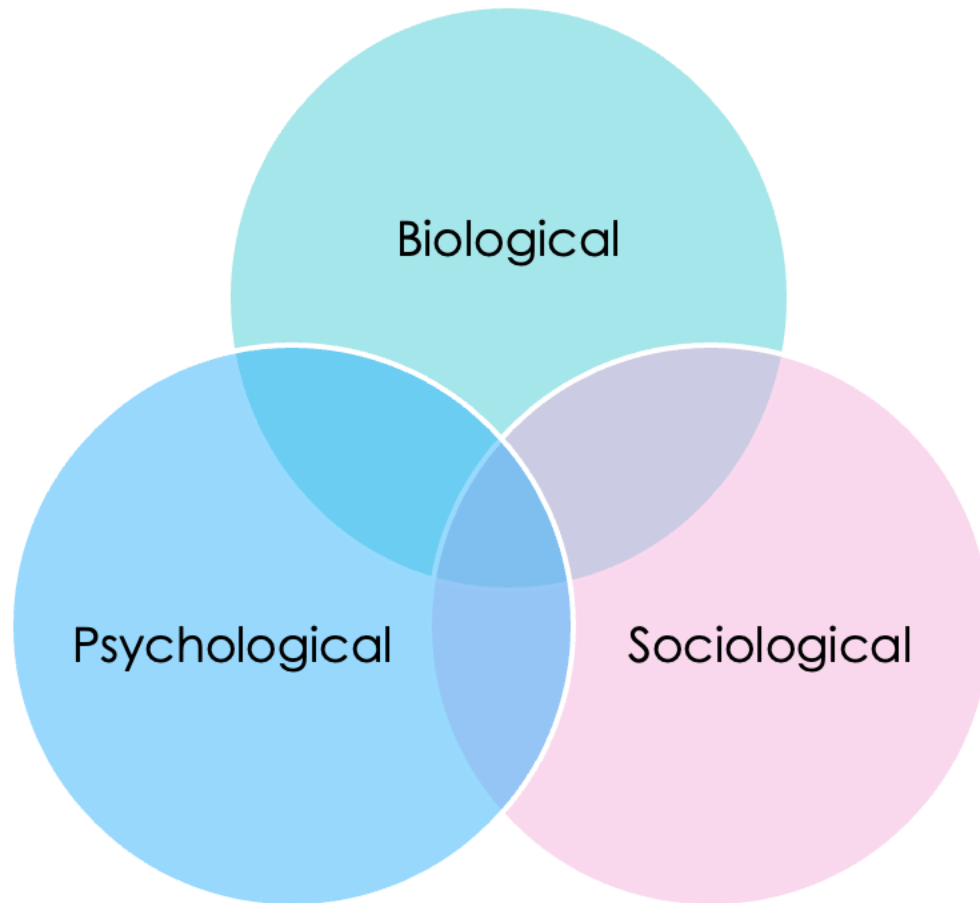


Biomedical model of disease





The biopsychosocial model of disease





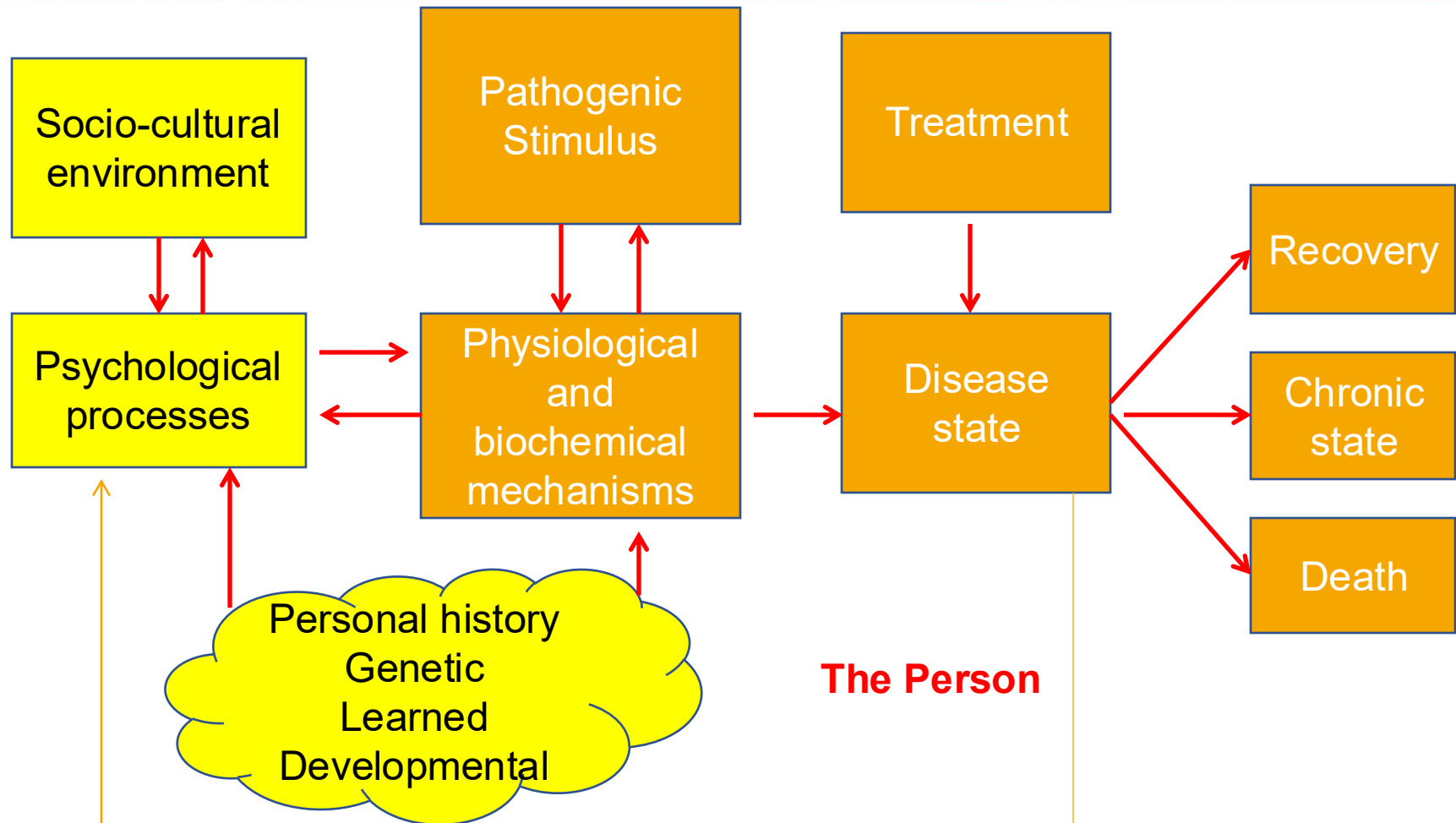
Biopsychosocial model of illness

Illness is thought to be caused by a combination of:

Biological	Psychological	Social
Viruses Bacteria Genetics	Behaviour Beliefs Stress Emotions Expectations	Socio-economic status Employment Influence of others Support networks



Biopsychosocial Model





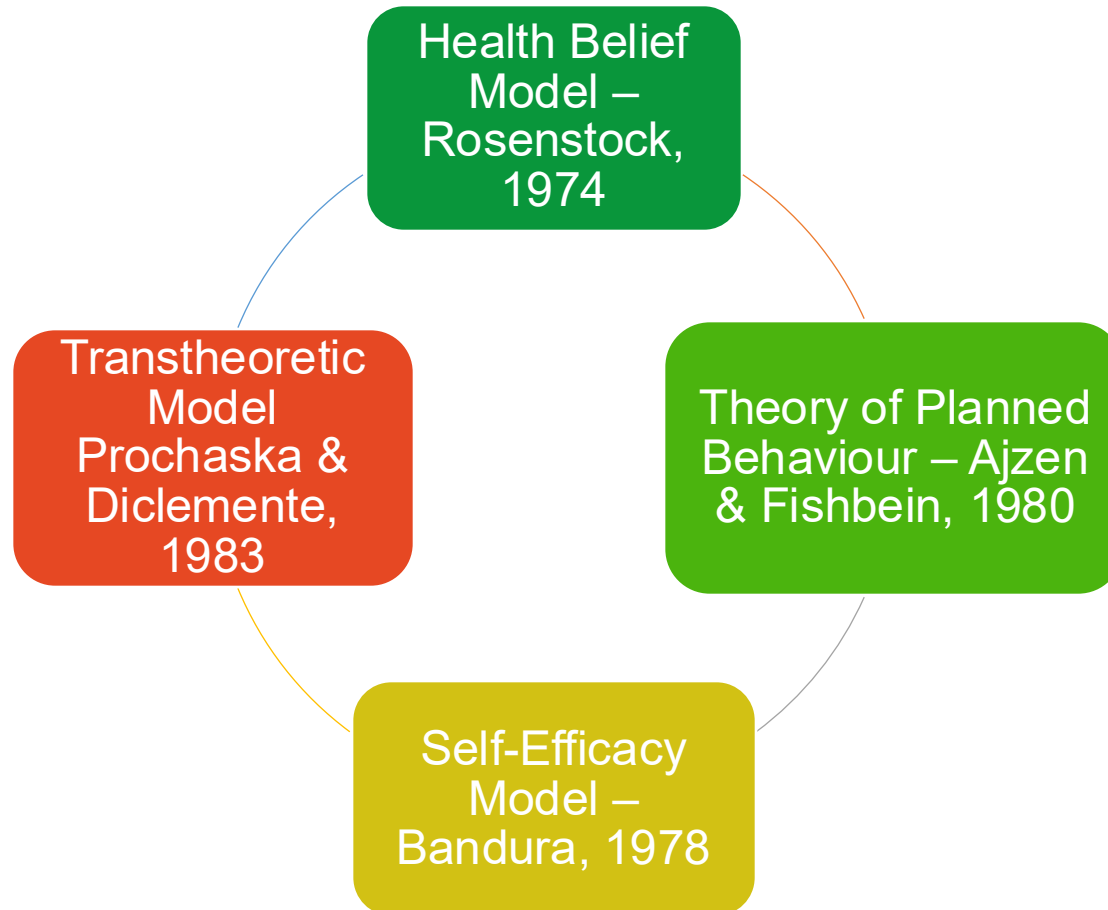
Health Behaviours





Question 2:

What are the key theories and models which help explain our health behaviours?





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Any questions?



CLQ poster assignment

Initial post: Your first task is to design a theory-led **health promotion poster**. You can choose one of the following health promotion issues to focus on:

- Discouraging excessive alcohol consumption.
- Promoting 30 minutes of exercise per-day.
- Reducing daily sugar intake.

The poster must be theory-led, therefore, you must use one of the following theories to inform the creation of your poster:

- The health belief model.
- The theory of planned behaviour.
- Self-efficacy theory.



CLQ poster assignment

Your poster must be engaging, easy to read and understand, and informed by psychological research related to your chosen health promotion issues.

To create your poster, you should use an A4 size document on Microsoft Word or use 1 slide of a PowerPoint Presentation file. It can also be helpful to save your poster as a PDF file for submission. Please see the above guidance on how to format an academic poster.



Poster tips and guidance

Executive summary should be written in academic tone

References needed to support the summary

Think about the following questions:

Why is each part of my poster there?

What theory/research supports its inclusion?

Why have you chosen to focus on this particular variable/theory?



CLQ grading criteria

Criteria	Weighting	Expectation
Knowledge and understanding of the subject area	30%	Demonstrable understanding course materials and their relevance to the assessment
Critical analysis and evaluation	25%	Students should demonstrate their intellectual skills
Communication	20%	Initial Post to be made during the first week, with Peer Response made throughout the two-week activity.
Reading and referencing	25%	The most up to date APA Style of Referencing should be followed. The majority of the reading will be from journal articles and course textbooks, with evidence of some wider reading beyond materials recommended on the platform



Grading criteria for CLQ assignment

Knowledge and understanding of the subject area / conceptual issues under consideration

- Demonstrate module learning in units 1 and 2 relating to established concepts and principles of topic, i.e., social cognition models, health promotion and health behaviours.
- Include supportive research and demonstrate an understanding of the strengths and weaknesses.
- Write clearly and specifically. Focus on key points and avoid being overly descriptive.

Critical Analysis and Evaluation

- Find and demonstrate perspective in your discussion points to strengthen your argument. What position have you reached after considering the supportive evidence?
- Avoid being overly descriptive – aim to interrogate the data, methodology and argument of the research
- Consider the theory and real-world uses of it and **critique it**: in what circumstances are these theories useful? What are the **strengths and limitations** of this theory? How does this impact or support your argument?



Grading criteria for CLQ assignment

Communication

- Not just 'that was interesting!' Consider **what** was interesting and **why**? How does that demonstrate your learning?
- What did you learn from your peers **that is new**?
- Critique and disagree (academically and politely)
- Get your peers to clarify their thinking / ask for more details about their thinking process

Reading and referencing

- Read around the topic first (what does the current literature say?). Remember to use your module reading and find additional reading yourself
- **Include links** to research or readings that supports or demonstrates the points you are making
- Make sure to **re-state the information**, not just copy and paste it in word-for-word
- Use **APA Referencing** to cite and reference the literature used: make sure to check the APA Referencing Guide for help with this



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Any questions on the CLQ?



Check your understanding

Question 1: What does it mean to be healthy?

- There are many definitions of health that are utilized by lay and professional people alike. When working as a psychologist in the field of health it is important to understand what view of health is held by the people you are working with.
- Travis's illness-wellbeing continuum (1972) proposes that wellbeing includes mental and emotional health, as well as the presence or absence of illness.
- Illness-wellness is best understood by considering a combination of physical and psychosocial factors which are integrated.



Check your understanding

Question 2: What are the theories and models which help explain our health behaviours?

- Biopsychosocial model
- Social cognition models
- Health Belief Model
- Theory of Planned Behaviour
- Self-Efficacy Model
- Transtheoretical Stages of Change



How do the models work?

- Social cognition models can offer an explanation of what factors are likely to play a part in predicting our health behaviours.
- Social cognitive emphasises that we are as individuals information processors, i.e., we play an ACTIVE role in interpreting the world around us.
- The models focus on the SOCIAL CONTEXT of behaviour change as well as the cognitive processes we engage in.
- The idea is that it is an INTERACTION between social and cognitive processes that determine whether or not we engage in behaviour change.



References

- Abraham, C., & Sheeran, P. (2005). 'The health belief model' in: *Predicting Health Behaviour: Research and Practice with Social Cognition Models*, (2nd Ed.). Maidenhead: Open University Press, 28-80.
- Ajzen, I. (1991). The theory of planned behaviour. *Organizational Behaviour and Human Decision Processes*, 50, 179-211.
- Bandura, A. (1997). Self-Efficacy: *The exercise of control*. New York, NY: W. H. Freeman.
- Bandura, A. (1977a). Self-efficacy: Toward a unifying theory of behavioral change. *Psychological Review*, 84, 191-215.
- Janz, N.K., & Becker, M.H. (1984). The health belief model: A decade later. *Health Education Quarterly*, 11, 1-47.
- Rodham, K. (2010). *Health Psychology*. Palgrave Macmillan.
- Rosenstock, I. M. (1990). The health belief model: Explaining health behavior through expectancies. In K. Glanz, F. M. Lewis, & B. K. Rimer (Eds.), *Health behavior and health education: Theory, research, and practice* (pp. 39–62). Jossey-Bass/Wiley.



Discuss and Debate

a) What are the main influences on our health behaviours? Think about the many factors involved.



Discuss and Debate

b) What is the role of health promotion in building healthier life-styles? Debate the potential effectiveness of health promotion interventions.



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Next Seminar date: